

Seat Allocator

Instructions for printing seat stickers and exporting a numbered seating list

1. Printing Seat Stickers

Stickers show each student's name, course/instructor, and seat - peel one off and place it on that student's exam.

1. Open the Seat Allocator page in any web browser. It works fully offline once loaded - no installation or internet connection needed.
2. Select your room from the **Classroom** dropdown.
3. Enter your class size in **Students**.
4. *(Optional)* List any seats to skip (e.g. broken chairs) in **Leave empty**, such as A5, H12.
5. Click **Allocate Seats**. This randomly picks spaced-out seats for your class size and shows the classroom map.
6. Scroll down and click **Print seat stickers with student names** to open that section.
7. Paste or upload your roster into the text box, **one student per line, in the same order as the Roster (TXT) download** (see Section 2). Use this format:
Last, First [Middle][, Course-Section]

For example, two student names on two separate lines:
Doe, Jane, MATH 140-510
Smith, John, Math 140-510
8. *(Optional)* To pin one particular student to an exact seat instead of letting Allocate Seats choose - for example, an accommodation seat - add the seat ID as a 4th column. That student's seat is used exactly as given, bypassing randomization for them only:
Cooper, Evan, Math 151-501, D12
9. *(Optional)* Enter your last name in **Instructor Last Name**. It's added to the course line (e.g. MATH 140-523 - Jones). If a student's course/section is left blank on purpose (for example, to withhold section information for some students), your name still appears on its own.
10. Choose your label sheet from **Label sheet** - Avery 5160, 5163, 14432, 14433, 14438, or a custom size.
11. Leave **Randomize which student gets which seat** checked to shuffle students across the allocated seats, or uncheck it to match your roster directly to seats in seat-ID order (this matches the Roster (TXT) numbering from Section 2 exactly, line for line).
12. Choose **Print order** - **Classroom Map** (default) prints the stack by seat ID (A1, A2, ... then B1, B2, ...); **Alphabetical Order** prints it by last name instead. This only changes the order stickers come off the printer - it never changes which seat a student is assigned.
13. If a test print lands off-center on your label sheet, adjust **Nudge right / Nudge down** (in millimeters) and print again.

14. Click **Generate Stickers (PDF)**.
15. Print the downloaded PDF at **100% / Actual Size** - do not use "Fit to page" or any other scaling option, or the stickers will not line up with your label sheet.
16. Peel off each sticker and place it on that student's exam, in the order you chose above.

Note: the roster you paste here is processed entirely in your browser to build the PDF - it is never uploaded or saved anywhere.

2. Generating a Numbered List (No Names) and Adding the Seat Column to Excel

If you'd rather keep names out of the process entirely and merge seat assignments into your own roster spreadsheet yourself, use the plain numbered list instead of stickers.

1. After clicking **Allocate Seats** (step 5 above), click **Roster (TXT)** to download `allocated_seats.txt`.
2. Each line of that file is just a sequence number, a tab, and a seat ID - no student names at all. It's numbered in seat-ID order (A1, A2, ... then B1, B2, ...), so **line k is the seat for student k** in your own roster, in whatever order you list them. For example:

1	A1
2	A14
3	B7
...	
3. To add this seat column to your existing Excel roster:
 - a. Open `allocated_seats.txt` in any text editor (Notepad, TextEdit, VS Code). Select all (**Ctrl+A / Cmd+A**) and copy (**Ctrl+C / Cmd+C**).
 - b. In Excel, click the cell next to your first student's name and paste (**Ctrl+V / Cmd+V**). Excel splits the pasted text at the tab automatically - the sequence numbers land in one column and the seat IDs in the next.
 - c. Delete the sequence-number column. What's left is your seat assignments, aligned row-for-row with your roster.

Alternative (Excel for Windows): *Data* → *From Text/CSV*, choose the file, set the delimiter to *Tab*, then untick the first column in the preview before clicking *Load*.

Note: this file never contains student names, so it can be stored, shared, or emailed without exposing any student's identity.

A sample roster file is included alongside this guide, formatted for direct paste into the sticker roster box in Section 1.